

Introduction to Social Psychology

Objectives of chapter 1



- Definition
- The past developments of the field
- The present of social psychology

Questions

Introduction

The scientific study of
behavior and mental
processes

The Subfields of Psychology:

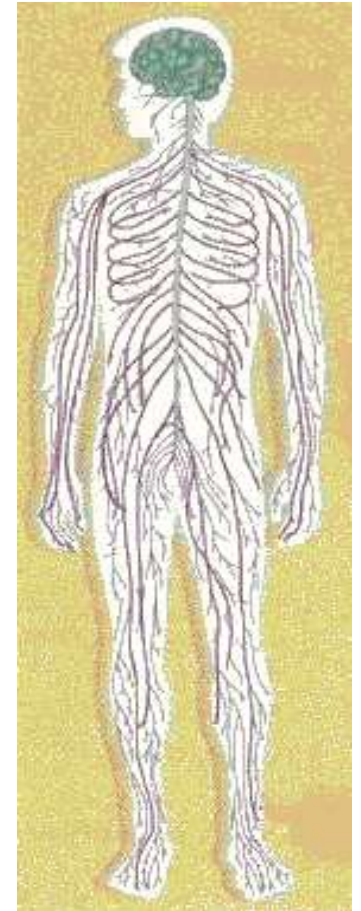
Psychology's Family Tree

Biopsychology

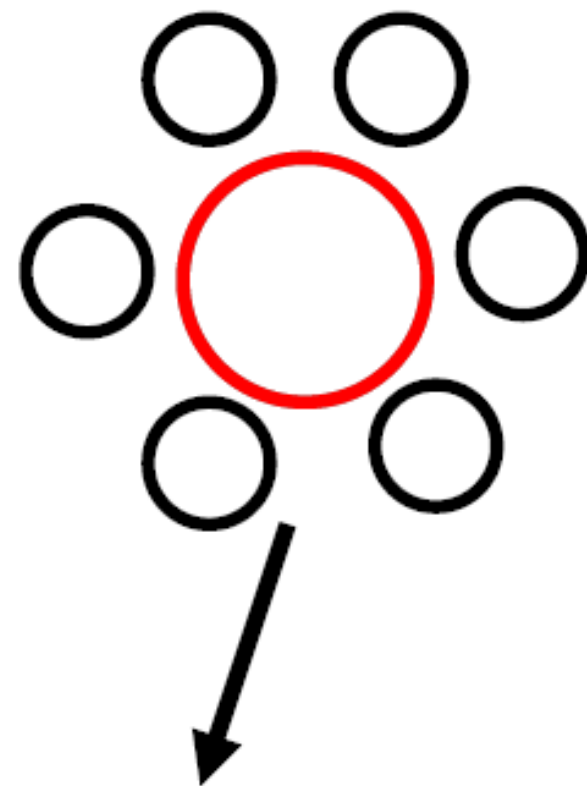
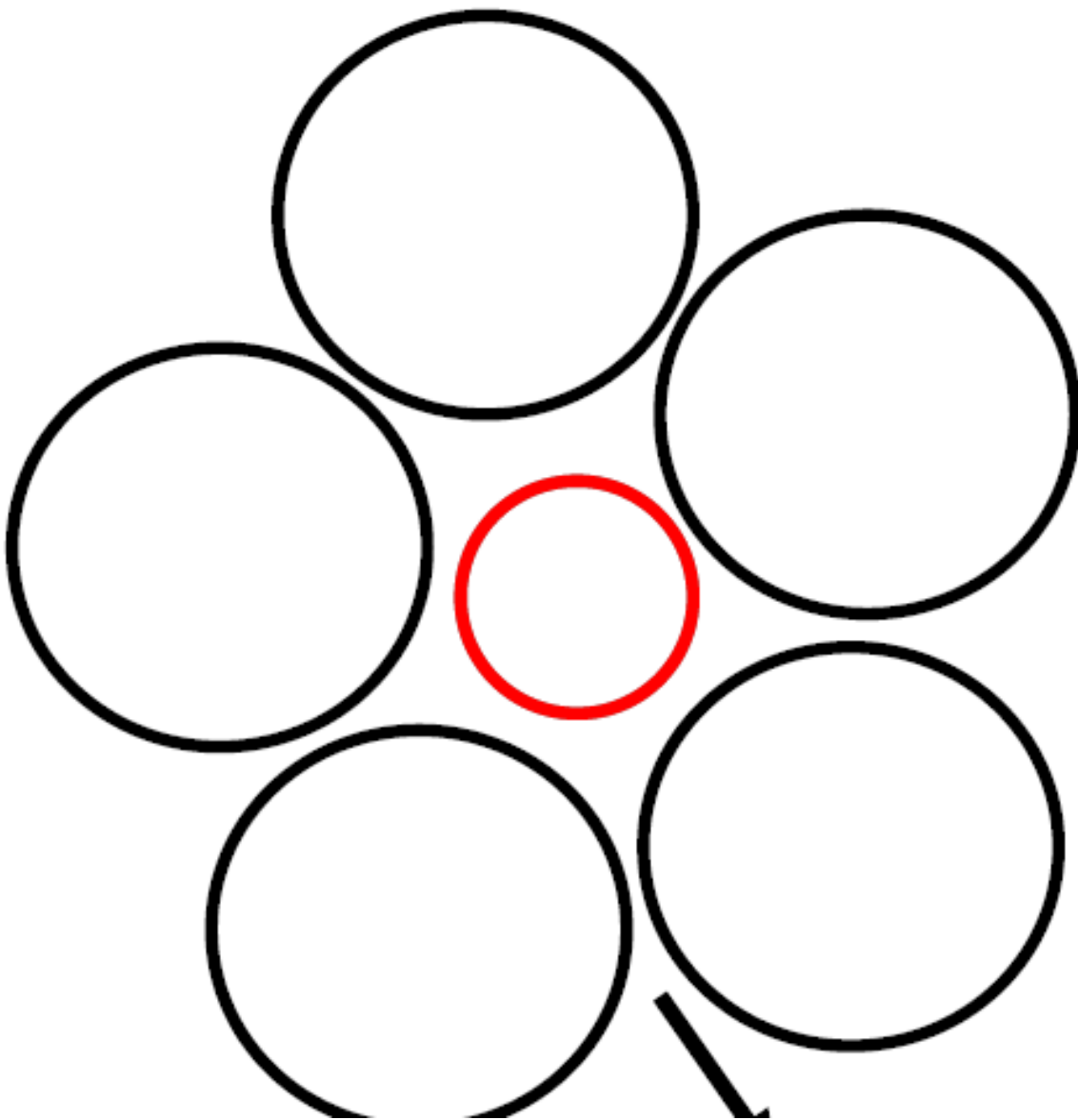
- Specializes in the biological bases of behavior

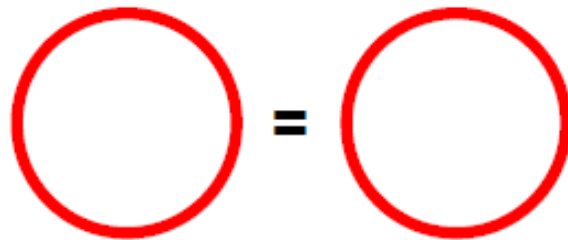
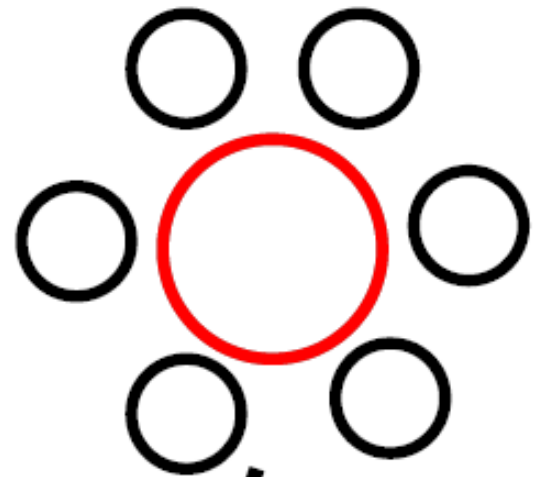
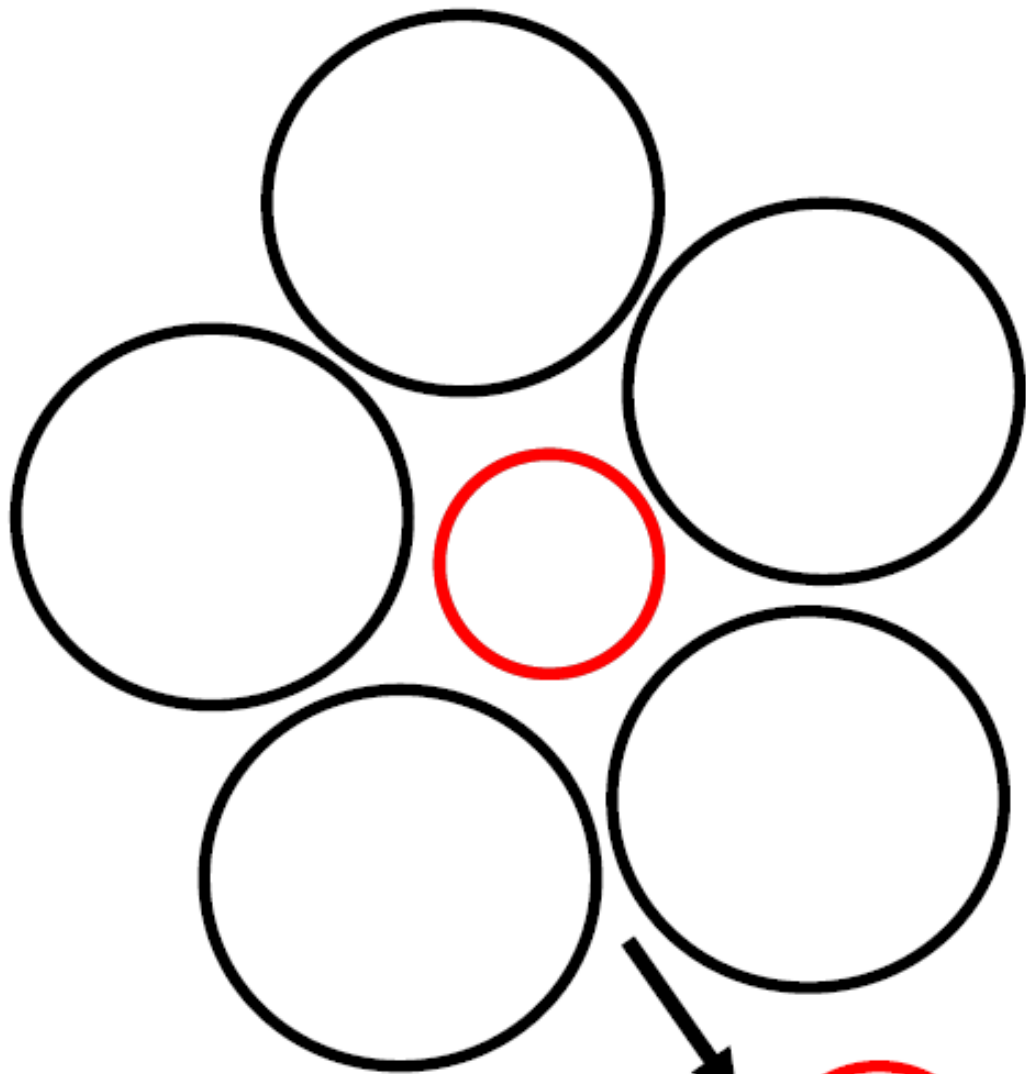
Sensation, perception, learning and thinking

- Experimental psychology
 - Methodological study of sensing, perceiving, learning and thinking
- Cognitive psychology
 - Emphasis on higher mental processes



Which red circle appears to be larger?





Ebbinghaus

Physical and mental health

– Health Psychology

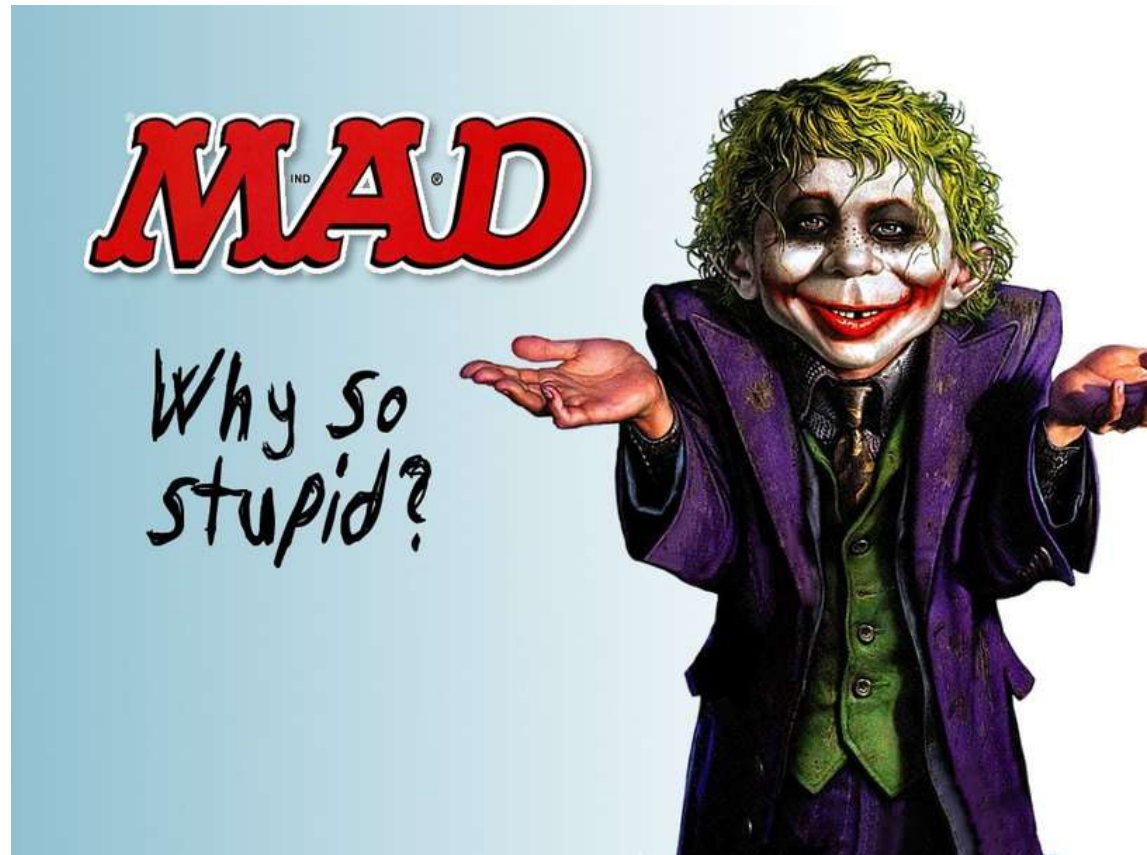
- Explores relationship between psychological factors and physical ailments or disease



Physical and mental health

– Clinical Psychology

- Investigates diagnosis and treatment of psychological disorders



Physical and mental health

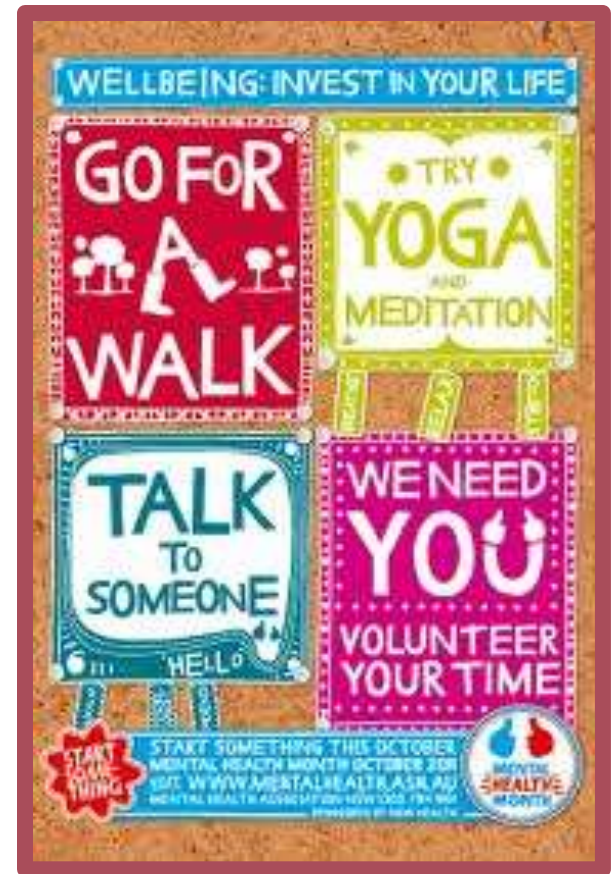
– Counseling Psychology

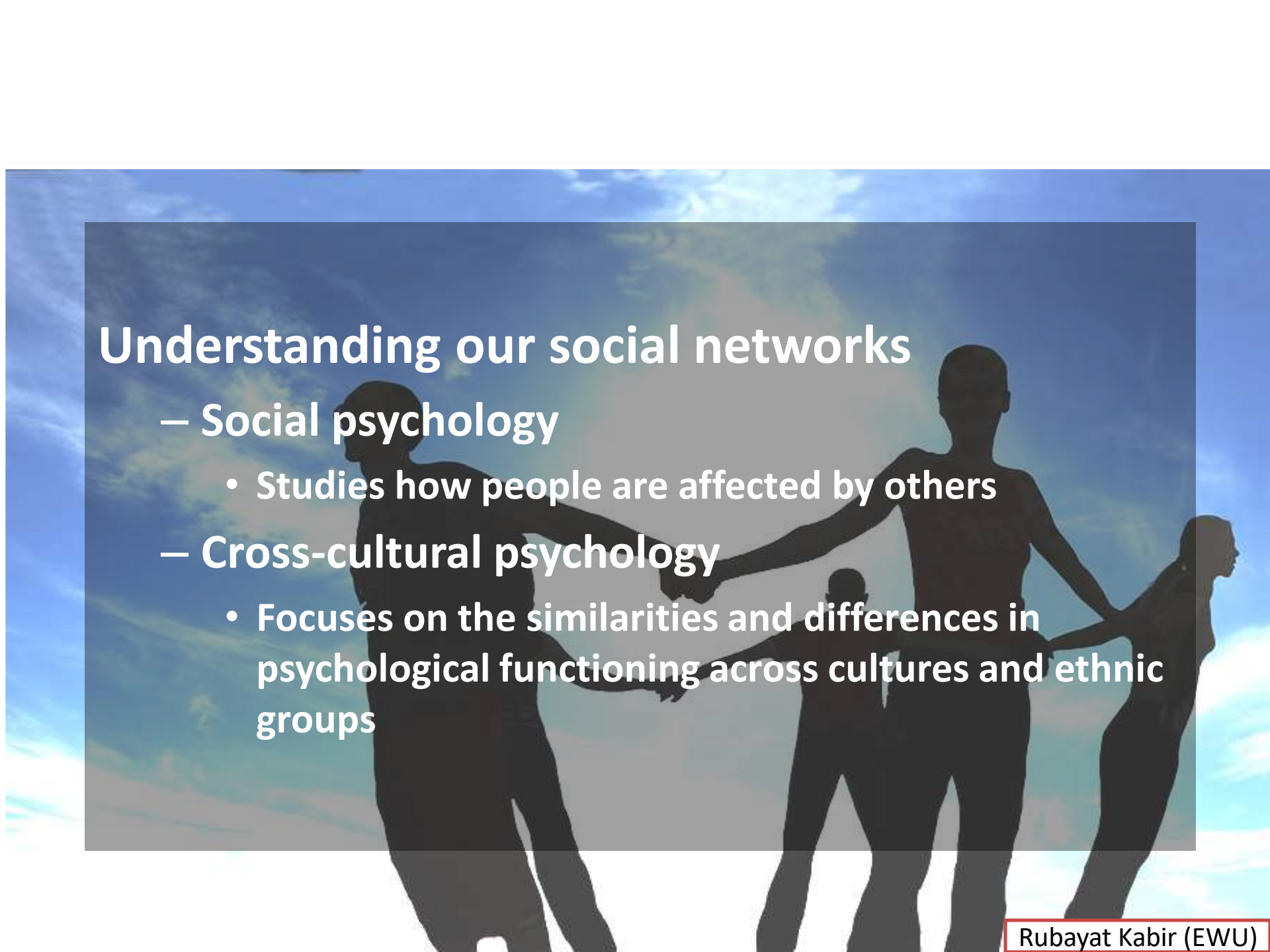
- Focuses on educational, social, and career adjustment problems



Sources of change and stability in behavior

- Developmental psychology
 - Changes in behavior over the lifespan (womb to tomb)
- Personality psychology
 - Examines consistencies in people's behavior over time and traits that differentiate us from one other



The background of the slide features a blue sky with wispy white clouds. In the foreground, the silhouettes of four people are shown from the waist up, holding hands in a circle. The silhouettes are dark and contrast sharply with the lighter sky. The text is overlaid on the left side of the image.

Understanding our social networks

– Social psychology

- Studies how people are affected by others

– Cross-cultural psychology

- Focuses on the similarities and differences in psychological functioning across cultures and ethnic groups

Introduction

- Our actions, thoughts and feelings are affected by the presence of others.

Definition

- **Gordon Allport (1954)** social psychology is a discipline that uses **scientific methods** in “an attempt to understand and explain how the thought, feeling and behavior of individuals are influenced by the **actual, imagined or implied presence** of other human beings”.

Definition

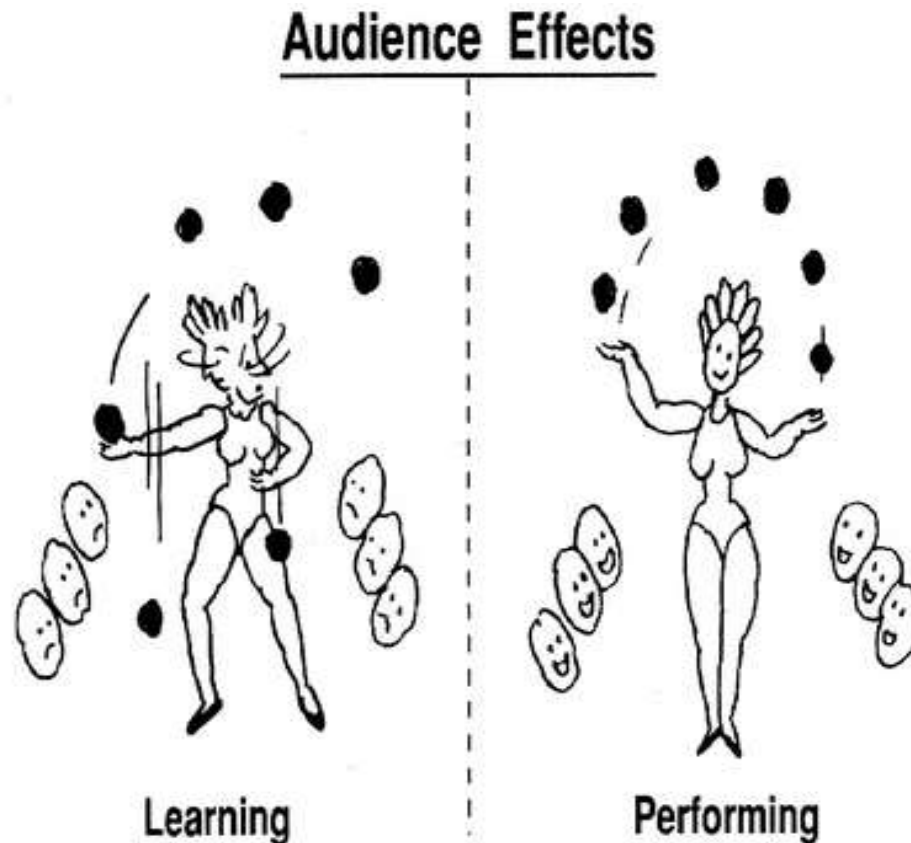
- **Barron and Byrne (2007)** defined social psychology as “the scientific field that seeks to understand the nature and cause of individual behavior and thought in social situations”.

Developments

- Norman Triplett (1898) applied the experimental method to investigate the performance of **cyclists and school children** on how the presence of others influences overall performance.

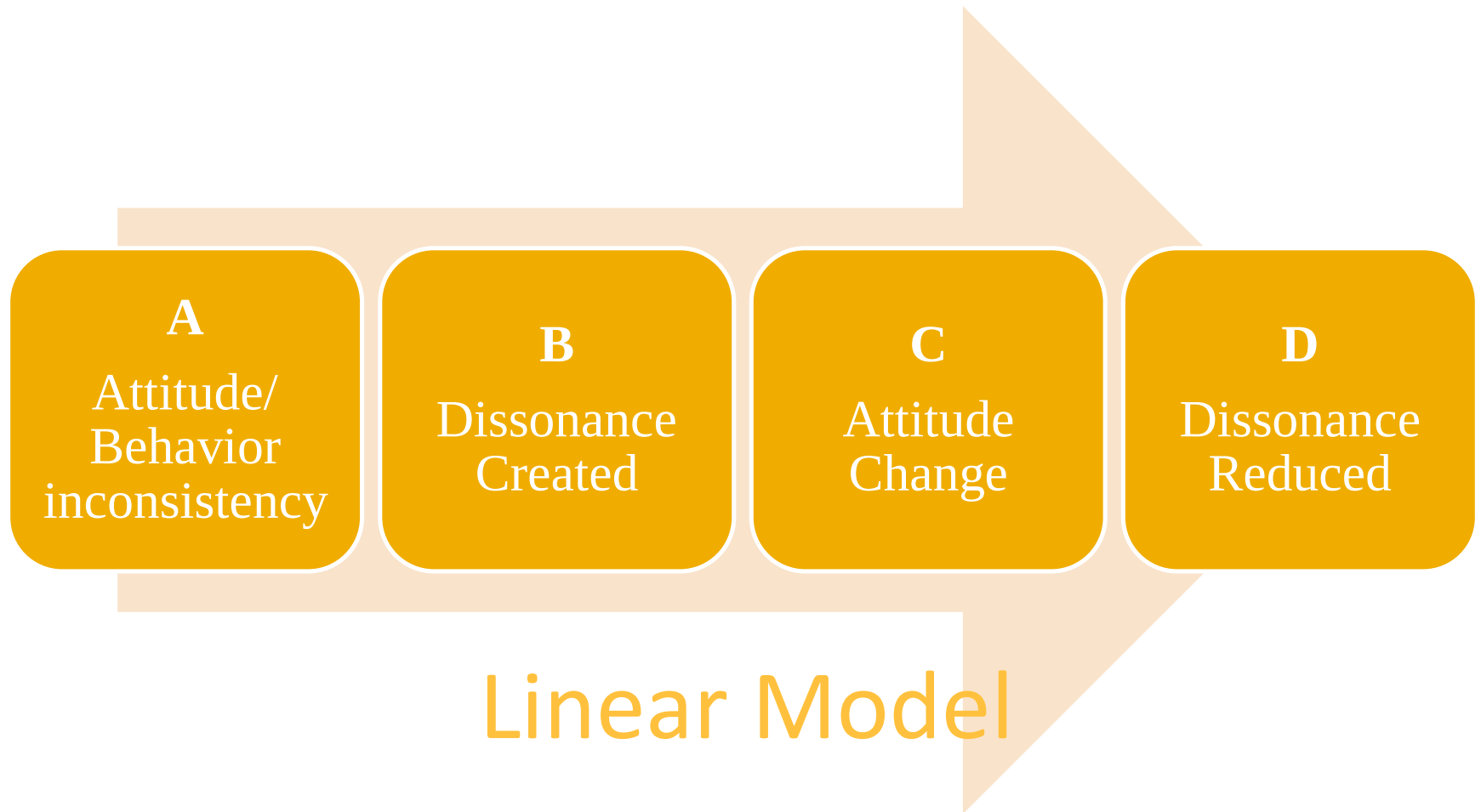
Developments

Floyd Allport (1920) – **Social Facilitation**



Developments

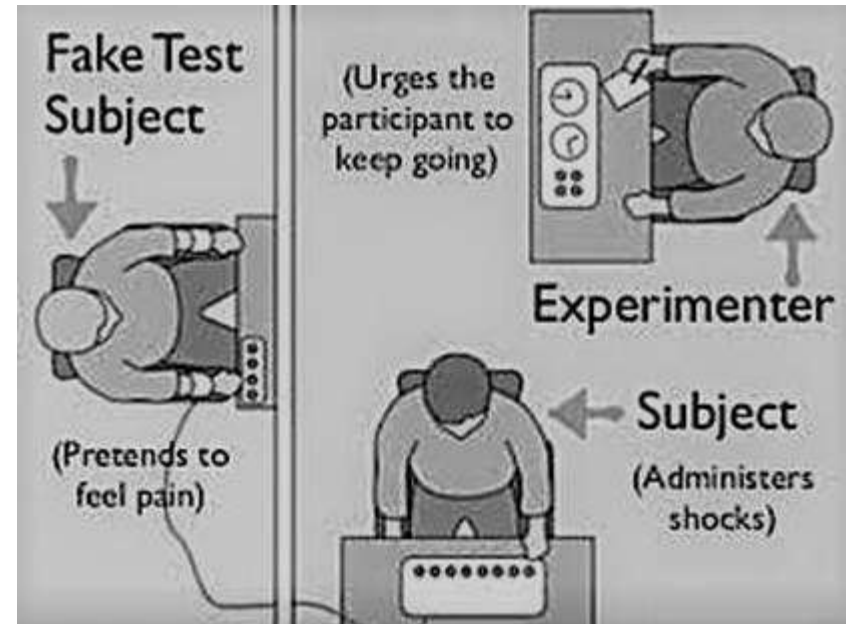
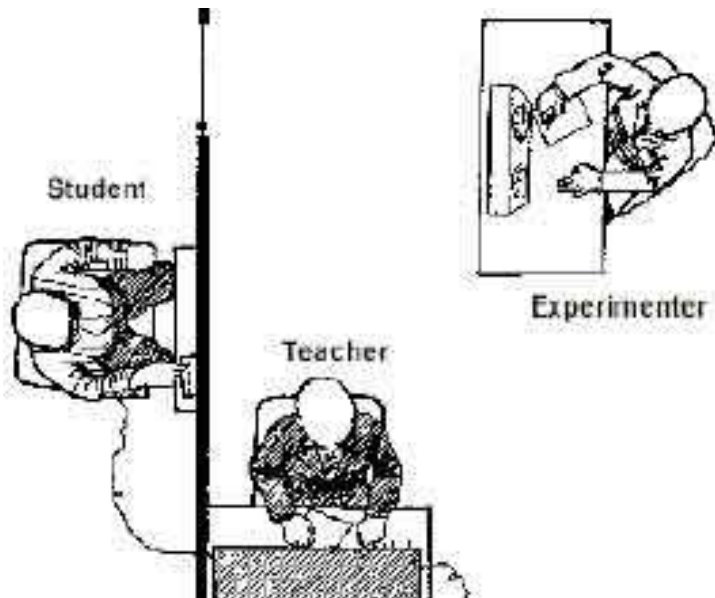
- Leon Festinger (1957) - **Cognitive Dissonance Theory**
 - Cognitive dissonance occurs when there is **inconsistency** between 2 cognitions
 - Cognitions: knowledge, opinions, beliefs (relating to self, behaviour, or environment)
 - Dissonance: A state of psychological tension which motivates people to do something to get rid of it to resume cognitive consistency



Developments

Stanley Milgram (1963)
– **Shock experiment**

65% of participants continued to 450 volts.



Developments

- Philip Zimbardo & colleagues (1971) – **Prison Study**
- Stanford University
- 24 participants (1drop, 2reserves, 10prisoners, 11guards).
- 6days.

Arrest

- https://www.youtube.com/watch?time_continue=28&v=sYtX2sEaeFE&feature=emb_logo

Prison days

- https://www.youtube.com/watch?time_continue=47&v=uTdttd7XTfQ&feature=emb_logo

Reactions

- https://www.youtube.com/watch?time_continue=48&v=fQnOkmvig_i0&feature=emb_logo

Developments

- Darley & Latané (1968) - **Diffusion of responsibility**
 - The presence of people (i.e., bystanders) influences an individual's likelihood of helping a person in an emergency situation.
 - If the number of people present in an emergency situation increases, the less likely it is that any individual will help someone in need.

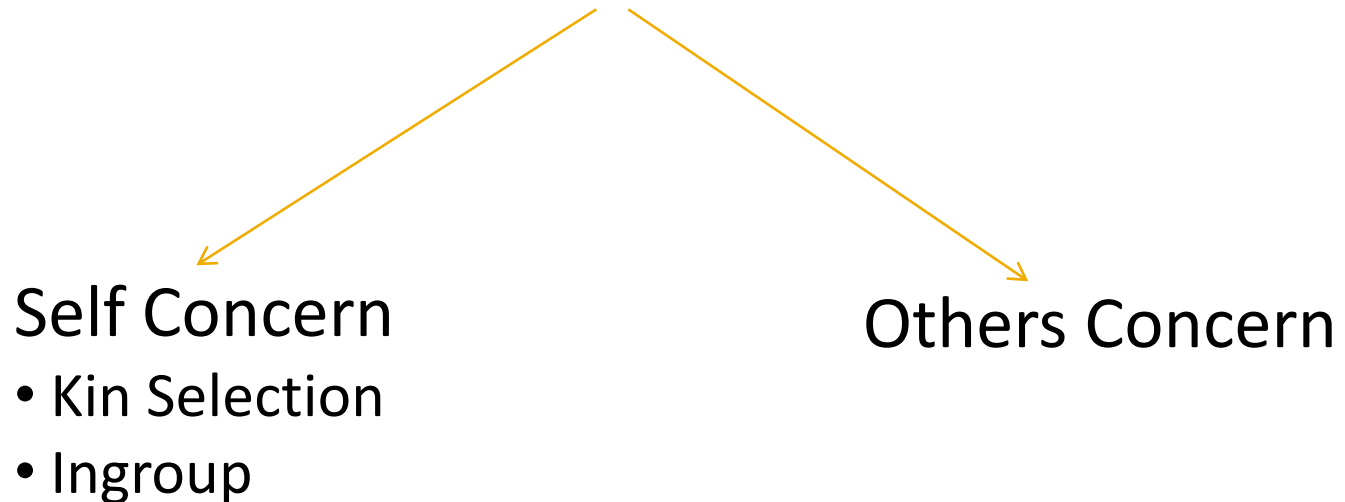
Developments

- Irving L. Janis (1972) - **Groupthink**
 - A phenomenon in which people strive for consensus within a group.

The Person and Social Situation

- Social Influence
 - Person - Situation Interaction

Evolutionary Adaptation (Fitness)



Influences based on emotions



The Social Situation Creates Social Influence

- Social support
- Social norms
- Culture
 - Individualism and Collectivism

Reference

- Stangor, C. (2012). Social Psychology Principles. v.1.
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- Feldman, R.S. (2011). Understanding Psychology (10th ed.).
4-7. McGraw Hill.